

Dichotomy

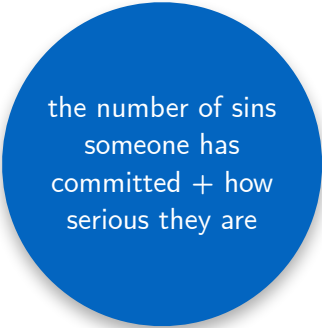
Non-
universality

Proportion- ality

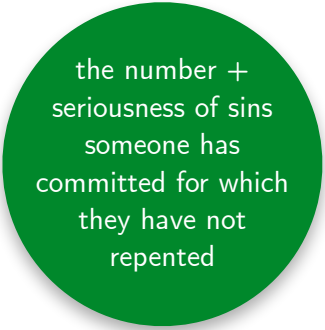
Continuity

A large, solid orange circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the number of sins someone has committed" is written in white, lowercase, sans-serif font, centered horizontally and vertically.

the number of sins
someone has
committed

A solid blue circle with a slight drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the number of sins someone has committed + how serious they are" is written in a white, sans-serif font, arranged in four lines.

the number of sins
someone has
committed + how
serious they are

A solid green circle with a slight drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the number + seriousness of sins someone has committed for which they have not repented" is written in a white, sans-serif font, arranged in six lines.

the number +
seriousness of sins
someone has
committed for which
they have not
repented



the person's faith and
trust in God

A large, solid purple circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the person's decision to be with God" is written in a white, sans-serif font, centered horizontally and vertically.

the person's decision
to be with God



the
paradox of
heaven and
hell



replies to the
paradox



evil & lives
not worth
living

Let's turn to our last option: rejecting Proportionality.

Isn't it plausible that this professor is unjust precisely because he has decided to treat very similar students very differently?

This might seem at first like a tough way to go. Here's an example of treating people who are in relevant respects very similar in very different ways:

The dichotomous professor

The instructor of an introductory philosophy class has tired of the diversity of final grades for students from which he is forced to choose, and decides to simplify his grading scheme. He decides that every student with a final average of 89.50 or greater will receive an A, and every student with a final average lower than that will receive an F.

traditional doctrine of heaven and hell that he thinks are inconsistent with

the existence of a perfectly good God.

Let's try to layout Sider's reasoning by isolating the various features of the

“A certain traditional conception of the afterlife is *binary*. After death one proceeds either to heaven or hell. Heaven is very, very good; hell is very, very bad. There are no possibilities for the afterlife other than heaven and hell, and membership in heaven or hell is never indeterminate or a matter of degree. The problem with the binary conception is that it contradicts God's justice. God must employ some criterion to decide who goes to heaven and who goes to hell. No reasonable criterion would be sharp; any reasonable criterion will have borderline cases. But the binary conception of the afterlife allows for no corresponding fuzziness in how the dead are to be treated. Hell must therefore contain people who are nearly indiscernible in relevant respects from people in Heaven. No just God would allow such a monstrously unfair thing.”

heaven and hell based on certain properties of these people. We will have

It is part of the traditional doctrine that God decides whether people go to

open for what those properties might be; just have a name for them,

Let's call them the relevant properties.



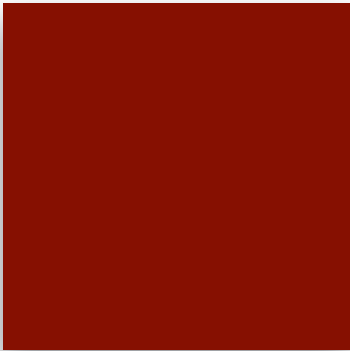


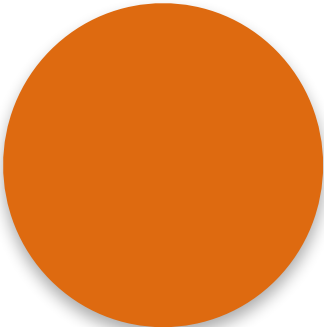


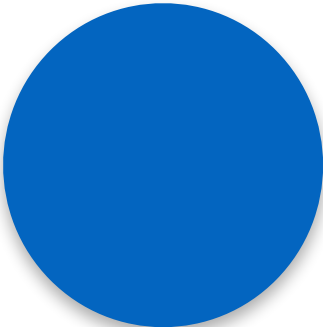


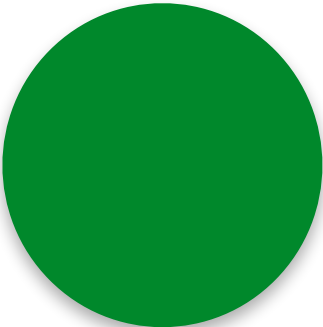


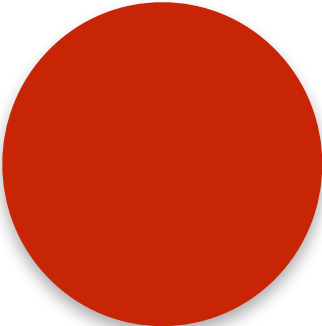
Proportion- ality















It seems difficult to deny Justice, Badness, or Divine Control. So that

seems to give the defender of the afterlife further main options.



replies to the
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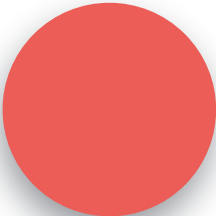
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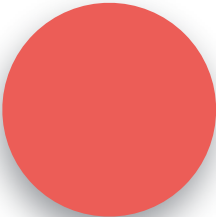






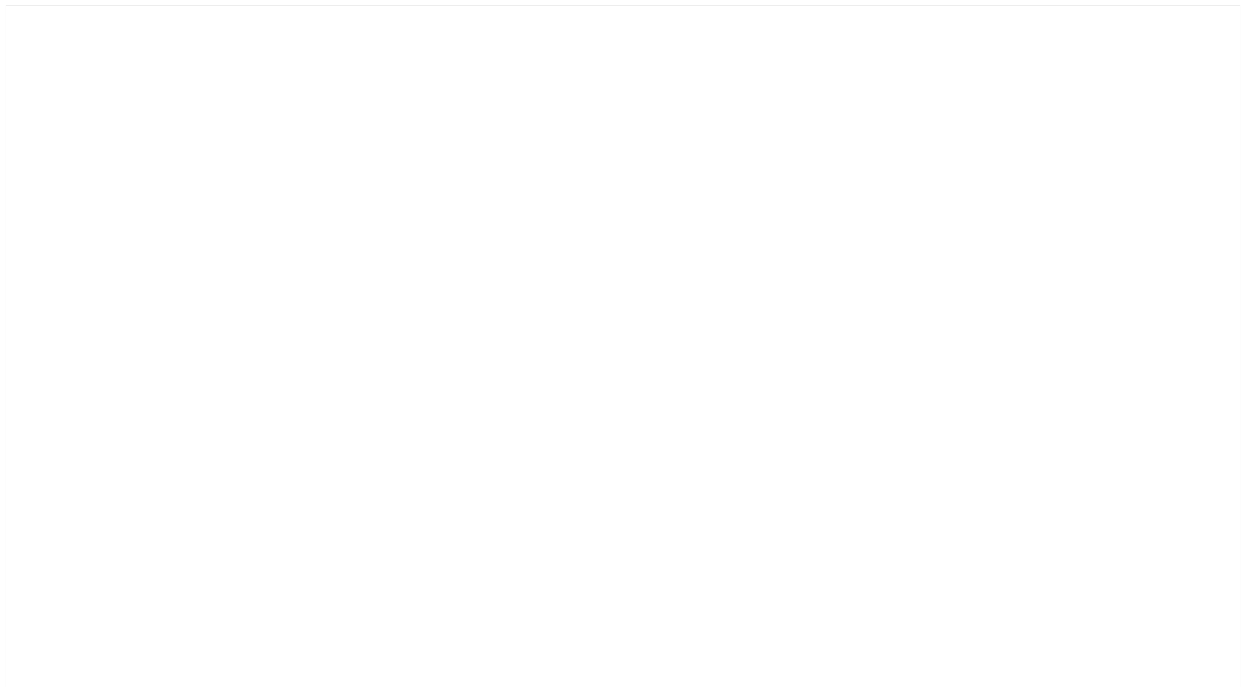
the
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describes the kind of view wanted to discuss:

The following passage from the Catechism of the Catholic Church



1038. The resurrection of all the dead, 'of both the

Judgment. Christ will come "in his glory, and all

just and the unjust,' will precede the Last

the angels with him... Before him will be gathered

goats, and he will place the sheep at his right hand,

into external punishment, but the rights into

all the nations, and he will separate them one from

eternis in die !!

another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

but the goats at the left.... and they will go away

One topic often associated with belief in God is the topic of life after death.

many of the major monotheistic religions compatible with the existence of a

perfectly good Good?

Our first question today is: what we are told about life after death by



this glory, and all the angels with him . . .

they will go away into eternal punishment,

as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

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Before him will be gathered all the nations,

the Last Judgment. . . Christ will come "in

and the wild sheep are then from another

goats, and the wild prairie sheep at his

right hand, but the goat at the left... and

but the rights are all in it.

1038. The reservation of the dead, "of

This certainly seems like a picture according to which, after death, God passes

judgement on all of us, and on the basis of our life, decides that some of us will

talk of the last judgment wouldn't make much sense.)

got to heaven forever, and some others to hell forever. (If not 'forever', then the

Turned-in showed why it is plausible that respo to the argument from evil

must depend on the possibility of life after death. We will now ask: is the kind of

view of life after death we get here on pain of being perfectly good?



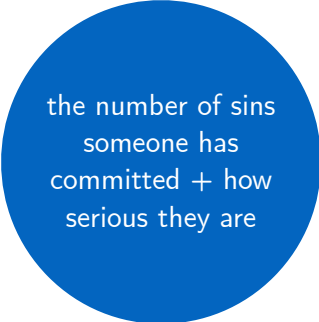




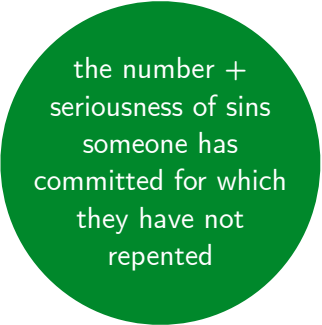
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Despite this, as I said in the article, a parallel

from the Bible might be used to cast doubt on Proportionality.

“The kingdom of heaven is like a landowner who went out early in the morning to hire men to work in his vineyard. He agreed to pay them a denarius for the day. About the third hour he went out and found some people in the marketplace doing nothing. He told them, “You also go and work in my vineyard and I will pay you what is right.” So they went. He went out again in the sixth hour and the ninth hour and did the same thing.

About the eleventh hour he went out and found still others standing around doing nothing. He asked them, “Why have you been standing around all day doing nothing?” “No one has hired us,” they replied. He said to them, “You also go and work in my vineyard.”

When evening came, the owner of the vineyard asked his foreman to call in the workers and pay them their wages, starting with the ones who were hired last. The workers who were hired about the eleventh hour each received a denarius. So those who were hired first expected to receive more. But each one of them also received a denarius.

When they received it, they began to grumble against the landowner, “These men who were hired last have worked only one hour, and you have made them equal to us who have worked in the heat all day.”

The landowner said, “Friend, I am not being unfair to you. Didn’t you agree to work for a denarius? Take your pay and go. I want to pay the people who were hired last the same as I paid you. Don’t I have the right to do what I want with my own money? Or are you envious because I am generous?”

Dichotomy

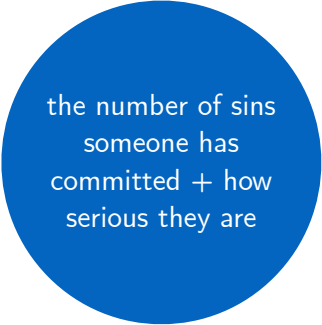
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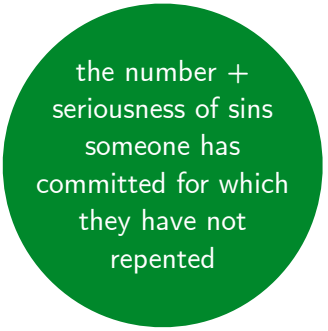
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